



28 The Computer Inside You



40 Double Or Nothing!



46 Booster Boards

Digital Passion

Fuelling the pursuit of technology knowledge

Lead Feature

Hybrid Horsepower

Electric cars have moved on, and hybrids are attractive today. We also have fuel cell powered cars. Either way, it looks like technology will ensure a greener future for us

Aditya Kuber

With rising fuel costs, there's enough cause for concern that cars may soon become a mode of transport only for the rich. Far-fetched as it may sound, the reason for rising fuel costs is the exponentially falling availability of crude oil.

Contrary to other reasons that may have been cited (oil mafia and what not), this is a real threat, and may soon skyrocket prices of even the most mundane everyday supplies. How? Well, an economy depends upon oil and fuel for transporting goods and a rise in this commodity has a direct effect on everything else.

However, technological advances in the last few decades have given hope that this threat may just yet be avoided. The emergence of

hybrid cars—those that run on conventional fuel as well as alternative forms of fuel—has meant that there are cheaper options that may soon become a reality.

In first-world countries, there are cars that use hybrid technology successfully and commercially. For the moment, though, this is restricted to passenger cars, and is not available for bigger vehicles. But what exactly is a hybrid car and how does it work? Moreover, what are the alternative sources of fuel? We answer these and many more questions related to alternative motoring.

Hybrids

If a device uses two or more sources of power to run, it's called a hybrid. For example, we can even say that a moped is a hybrid, as it includes two types of energy input—a motorised engine and a foot pedal.

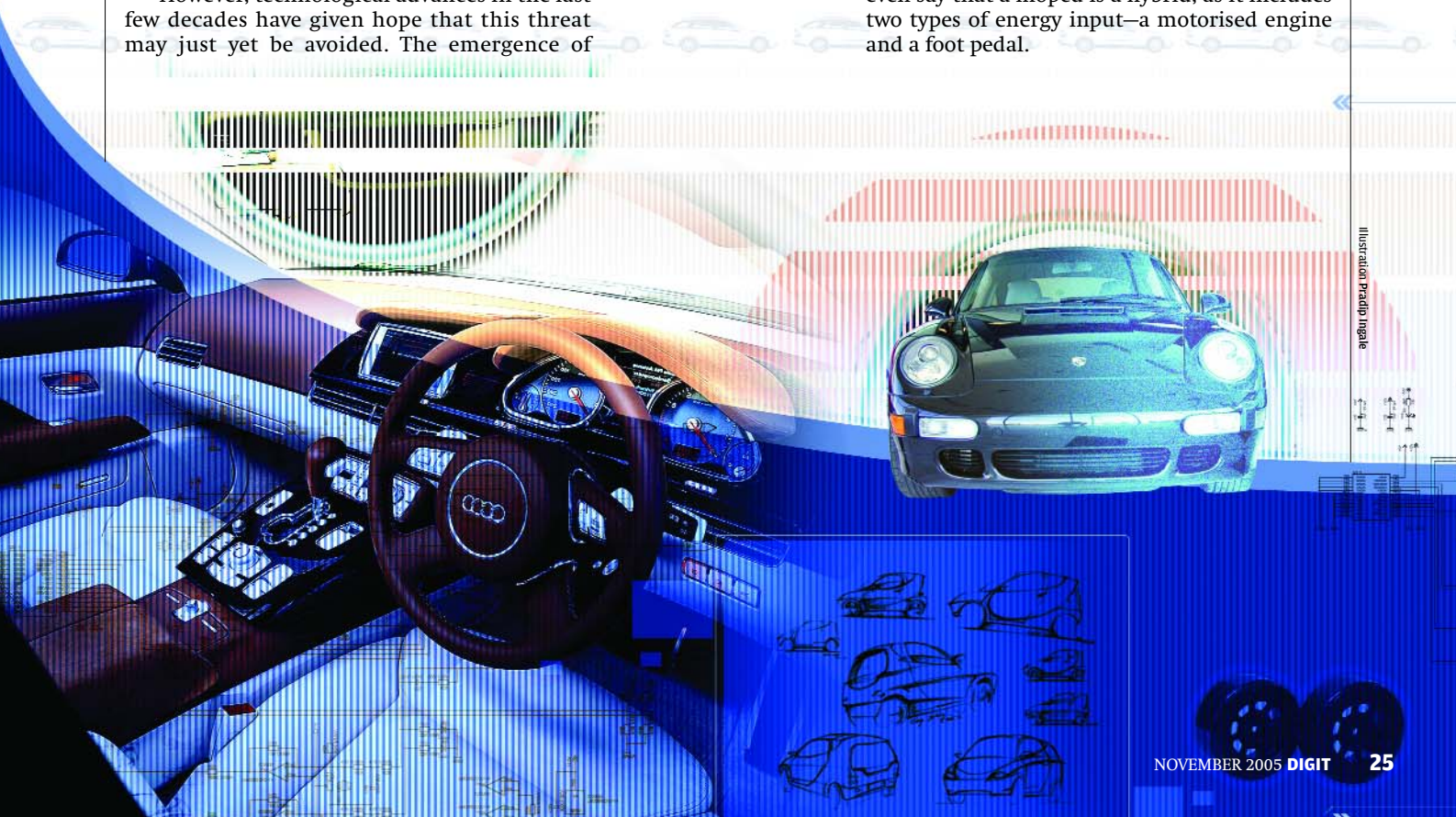


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